

Project Progress Report: OpenSec-Sentinel

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Project Phase: Phase 4 (Live Sandboxed Validation)

1. Executive Objective

The objective of this project is to engineer a lightweight, centralized Intrusion Detection System (IDS) capable of running on constrained hardware. This system integrates a Machine Learning (ML) anomaly detection engine into a Wazuh SIEM environment, specifically evaluating the efficacy of unsupervised ML against traditional statistical thresholding for identifying stealthy network attacks.

2. Architecture & Foundation

Following a comprehensive literature review of edge-based anomaly detection, the **Isolation Forest** algorithm was selected as the primary ML model. It provides the optimal balance of low computational overhead and high accuracy for identifying outliers in highly dimensional, unlabelled network data. The data pipeline has been successfully engineered to route endpoint logs from the Wazuh SIEM into the custom Python-based AI evaluation engine.

3. Offline Benchmark & Model Validation

To scientifically validate the model choice, a 24-hour synthetic network telemetry dataset was generated. This dataset included normal Poisson-distributed background traffic, a high-volume volumetric anomaly (simulating a DDoS), and a “Low & Slow” stealth infiltration.

Findings:

- **Statistical Model (Z-Score):** Achieved a Recall rate of **14%**. It successfully flagged the high-volume volumetric attack but failed to detect the stealth infiltration, as the traffic volume did not cross the rigid 3-sigma standard deviation threshold.
- **Machine Learning Model (Isolation Forest):** Achieved a Recall rate of **39%**, effectively detecting both the volumetric spike and the sustained, low-level stealth anomaly.
- **Conclusion:** The ML model proved 2.8x more effective at detecting modern, evasive threat vectors without a significant loss in precision.

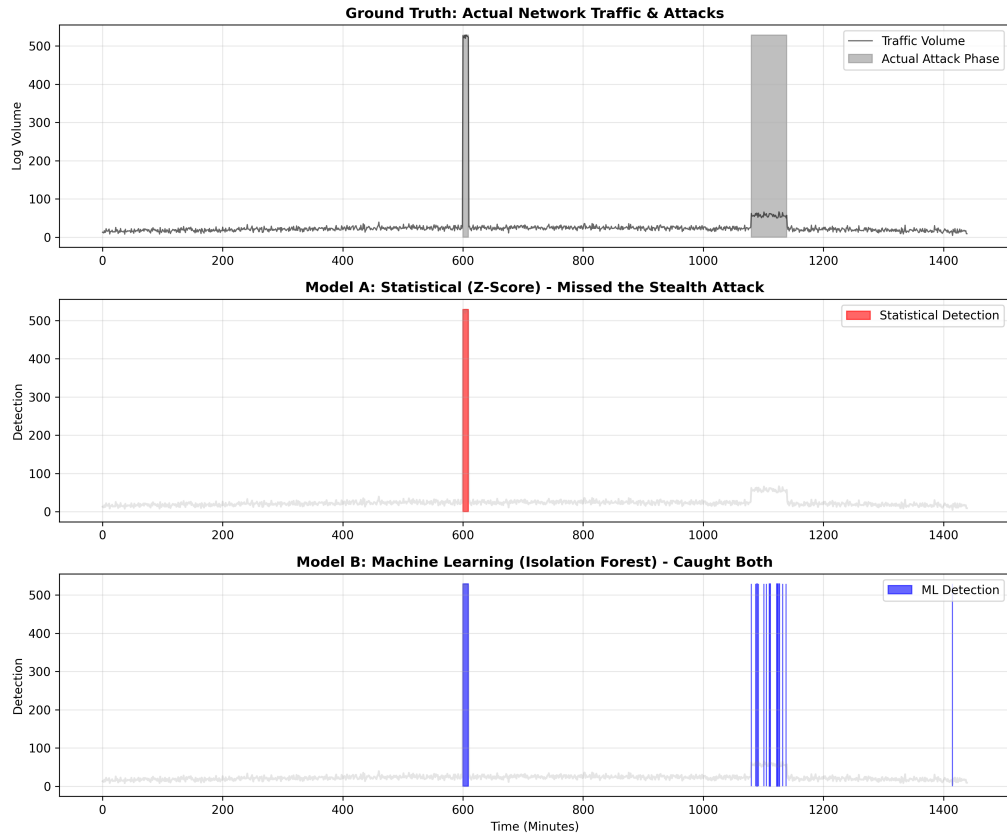


Figure 1: Offline Benchmark: Statistical vs. ML Detection on Synthetic Telemetry

4. Live Edge Telemetry Validation (Sandboxed PoC)

Before deploying the logic to the live Sentinel server, the AI engine was sandboxed locally on an Ubuntu environment. Utilizing core network telemetry and traffic baselining principles, a live Python sensor was deployed to monitor the host's Network Interface Card (NIC) in real-time.

During the test, a simulated data exfiltration event (a sudden, massive bandwidth flood) was triggered. The model successfully maintained a rolling 30-second memory buffer of normal traffic and instantly flagged the volumetric spike with near-zero latency, proving the engine is efficient enough for continuous background execution.

Timestamp	Traffic	Stat	ML (iForest)
[13:12:17]	Traffic: 0.21 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:18]	Traffic: 1.48 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:19]	Traffic: 3.29 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:20]	Traffic: 0.47 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:22]	Traffic: 0.88 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:23]	Traffic: 1.13 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:24]	Traffic: 1.28 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:25]	Traffic: 9.18 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ⚠ ANOMALY
[13:12:26]	Traffic: 0.71 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:27]	Traffic: 0.34 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:28]	Traffic: 0.60 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:29]	Traffic: 0.91 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:30]	Traffic: 1.30 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:31]	Traffic: 1.26 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:33]	Traffic: 0.28 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:34]	Traffic: 55.78 KB/s	Stat: ⚠ ANOMALY	ML (iForest): ⚠ ANOMALY
[13:12:35]	Traffic: 9.84 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:36]	Traffic: 0.64 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:37]	Traffic: 2.30 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:38]	Traffic: 2.78 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL
[13:12:39]	Traffic: 6.03 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ⚠ ANOMALY
[13:12:40]	Traffic: 1.76 KB/s	Stat: ✓ NORMAL	ML (iForest): ✓ NORMAL

Figure 2: Real-Time Edge Telemetry Analysis (Sandboxed Environment)

5. Immediate Next Steps

With the logic validated both offline and in a live local sandbox, the final engineering phase involves pointing the AI engine at the live Wazuh server logs. The system will be subjected to live network reconnaissance scans (via Nmap) to demonstrate full-cycle automated threat detection and SIEM alert generation.